



OPERATION DRAGOON



AIM

The Aim is to Analys the Operation Dragoon 1944

A tank is positioned on a severely damaged steel truss bridge over a river. The bridge's structure is heavily compromised, with large sections missing and the remaining framework leaning precariously. The tank's main gun is pointed towards the left. In the background, a multi-story building and bare trees are visible under a grey, overcast sky. The foreground shows debris and the river's surface.

INTRODUCTION



Google Earth
Google LK, Data SIC, NOAA

The Operation Dragoon



Allied forces invaded Southern France on 15 August 1944.

European Strategic Situation



Normandy, Mediterranean flanks and southern momentum.

Importance of Southern France?



Port logistics, Normandy link and vital ports.

Original Concept of Operation Anvil



Tied to Overlord, it opened southern France and split German forces.

D - Day



Mediterranean crossing, bombardment support and three-sector landings. 11

Campaign Area



Relative Forces Allied

Allied Forces

- 150,000+ troops
- highly motivated U.S. and French units
- Abundant modern tanks
- 800+ warships

German Forces

- 50,000 troops
- low morale
- Severe fuel and ammunition
- minimal navy

Allied Command

Supreme Command

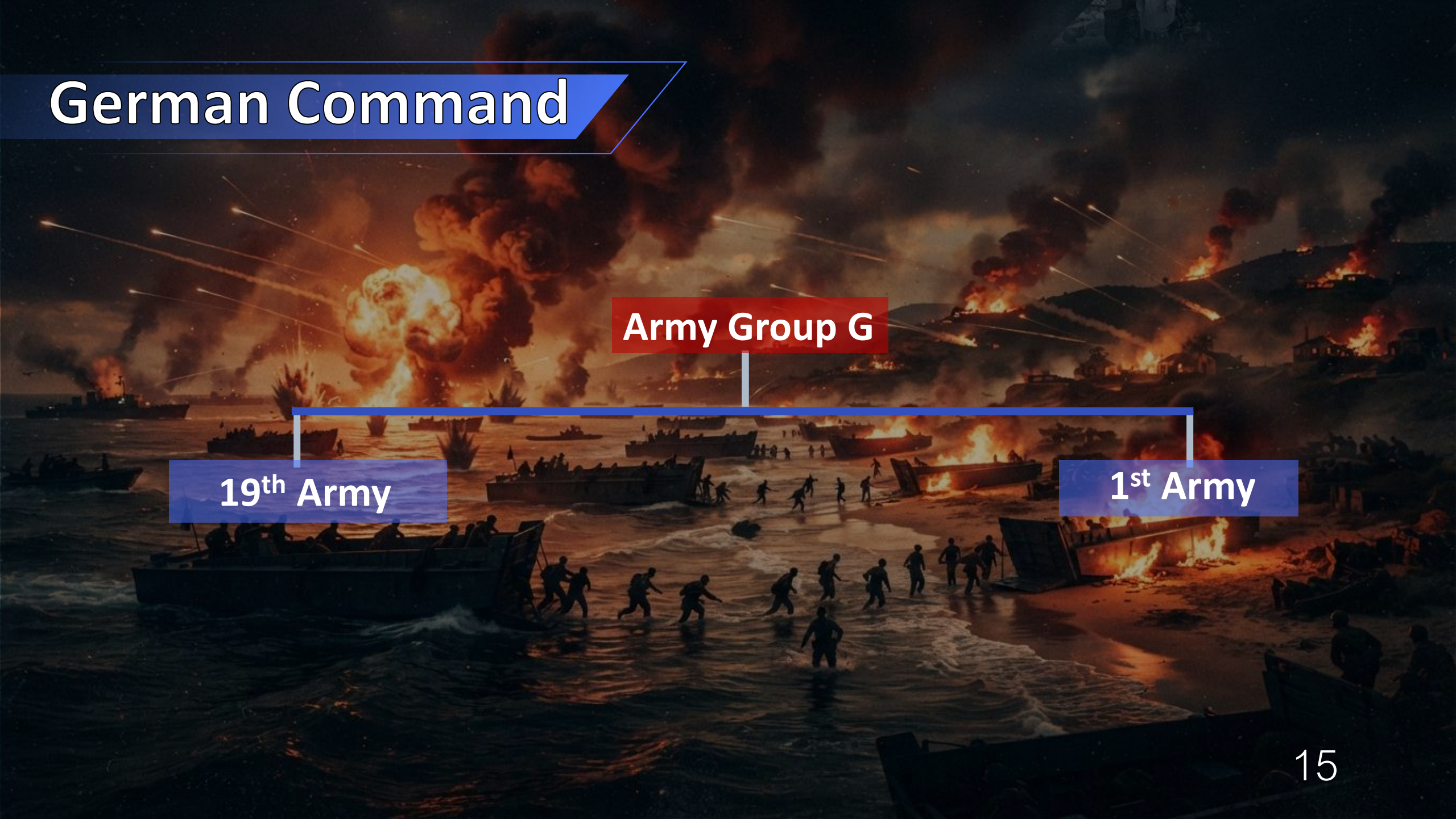
Ground Forces

Air and Naval

US VI Corps

French 1st Army

German Command



Army Group G

19th Army

1st Army

Special Operations



Conducted night raids, Enabled August 15 landings

Airborne Component



Argens drop, secured Le Muy and rapid seaborne link-up.

Naval Approach



Led by Vice Adm. Hewitt Synchronized with air strikes

Amphibious Assault Plan



Sea, air & ground ,Transport & protection, Beach & inland targets 19



Allied Operational Concept

- **Assault:** Three sectors
- **Airborne:** Secured Le Muy crossroads
- **Naval:** Suppressed coastal batteries

Airborne: Secured Le Muy crossroads

Allied Objectives



German Objectives



Defense



Preservation



Delay



A dark, rainy battlefield scene. In the background, there are large plumes of smoke rising from fires. The ground is dark and wet, with some small fires burning. The sky is overcast and rainy.

THE WAR BEGAN

Decision to Proceed



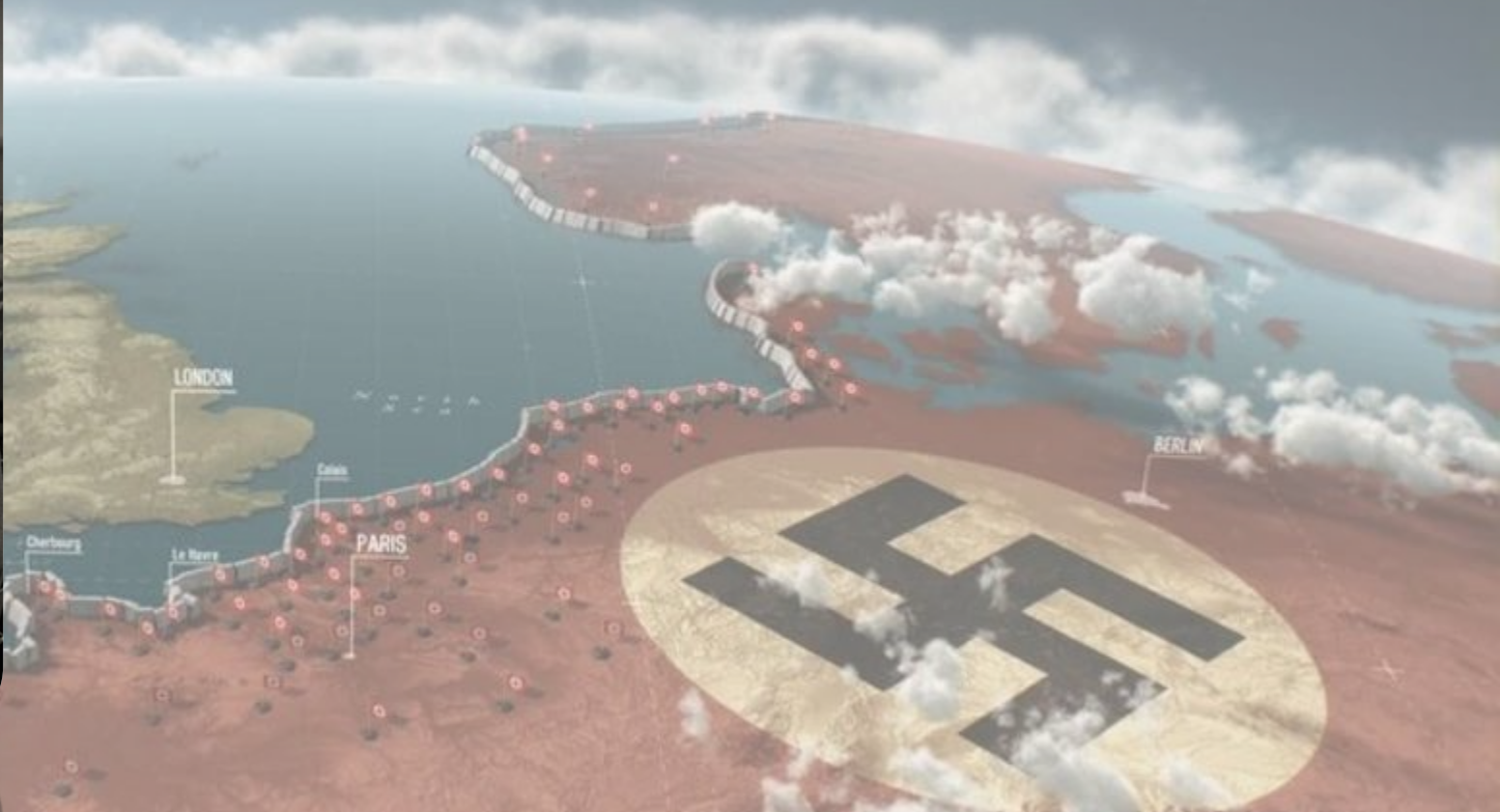
- **Decision Timeline**
- **Leadership Consensus**
- **Strategic Necessity**

Key Dates



- **Assault**
- **Exploitation**
- **Advance**

Intelligence Preparation



Ultra signals, resistance reports, and enemy mapping.

Three Main Landing Areas



Landing at Alpha



3rd Infantry Division hit Alpha Beach

Landing at Delta



- **Assault:** Allied forces hit Delta sector
- **Support:** Naval gunfire suppressed defenses
- **Advance:** Pushed inland

Landing at Camel



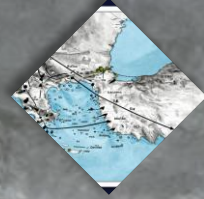
- **Assault:** Allies hit Delta
- **Support:** Naval bombardment
- **Advance:** Pushed inland

Airborne Landings



- **Insertion:** Night drops near Le Muy
- **Control:** Seized key road junctions
- **Security:** Secured beachhead flanks

First 24 Hours



- **Landing:** Over 90,000 troops in 24 hours
- **Consolidation:** Rapidly secured the beachhead
- **Expansion:** Perimeter grew with follow on forces

Establishment of the Beachhead



- **Perimeter:** Secured by Aug 15
- **Retreat:** Blaskowitz ordered a northward pullout
- **Supply:** Routes opened to Frejus

Allied Breakout



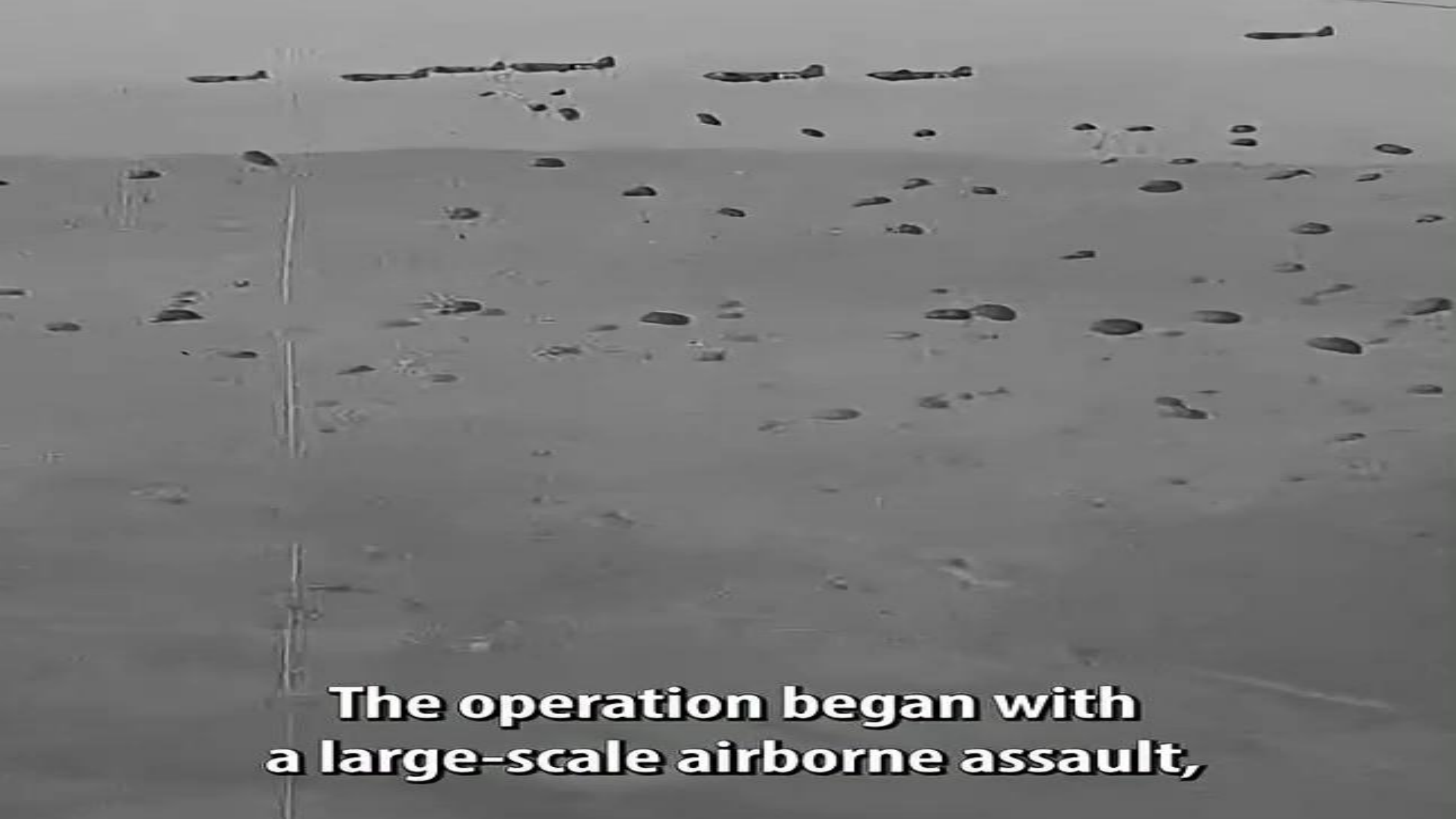
- **Breakout:** Rapid inland advance
- **Forces:** VI Corps and French First Army
- **Direction:** Drove north toward Rhône Valley

Link-Up Near Dijon



- Allied forces met Patton's army
- This completed the German encirclement
- Northern and southern fronts united





**The operation began with
a large-scale airborne assault,**

Hand Held Two Way Radio



Human Dummies



A dark, atmospheric scene of a battlefield during a rainstorm. In the background, there are large plumes of dark smoke rising from fires. The ground is dark and muddy, with several small, bright orange flames scattered across it. A few bare, skeletal trees stand in the distance. The overall mood is somber and chaotic.

WAR ANALYSIS

1. STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES



- **PORT CAPTURE**
- **PINCER LINK**
- **PRESSURE RELIEF**



2. COALITION FORCES



- **US SEVENTH ARMY**
- **FRENCH ARMY B**



3. INTELLIGENCE & DECEPTION



- OPERATION VENDETTA
- FRENCH RESISTANCE



4. LOGISTICAL TRIUMPH



- PORT RESTORATION
- SUPPLY FLOW



FLEXIBILITY ALLIED vs GERMAN RESPONSE

ALLIED

- Rapid beachhead expansion
- Shifting axes of attack
- Integrated air, naval and ground action
- Strategic aim maintained

GERMAN

- Communications disrupted
- Forces depleted
- Withdrawals compelled
- No stable defensive line

CONCENTRATION — OPERATIONAL EFFECT

NAVAL
GUNFIRE

AIR
SUPPORT

AMPHIBIOUS
LANDINGS

AIRBORNE
BLOCKING

LOCAL SUPERIORITY

RAPID BEACHHEAD → BREAKOUT → PORT CAPTURE

JOINT + COMBINED-ARMS INTEGRATION



Each step shaped the conditions for the next; the ground advance collected that synergy into operational reality.

LOGISTICS - THE OPERATIONAL LIFELINE

MEDITERRANEAN
SEA LIFT

TOULON +
MARSEILLE

REPAIRED PORT
CAPACITY

ADVANCING
ALLIED ARMIES

Operational tempo + tactical success



LESSON LEARNT

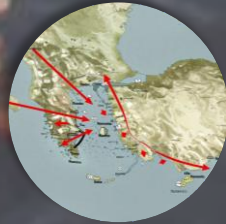
Selection & Maintenance of the Aim

- **Definition:** Commanders must define and pursue clear objectives
- **Allied Aim:** The Allies aimed to seize Toulon and Marseille for logistics
- **Alignment:** All operational phases focused on securing the ports



Maintenance of Morale

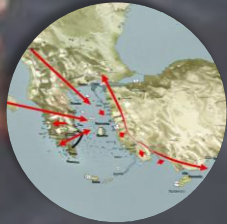
- Allied morale stayed high
- German morale collapsed
- Records prove these facts



Offensive Action



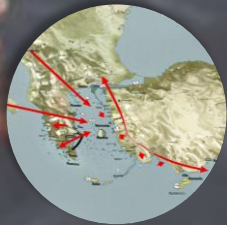
- **15 Aug:** Allied landing began
- **Breakout:** Rapid Allied advance
- **Result:** German forces weakened



Surprise

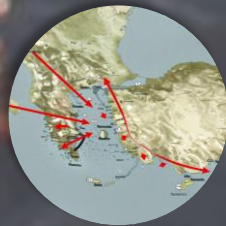


- **Dawn attack:** German forces unprepared
- **Combined attack:** Sea, air & airborne
- **Result:** German response delayed



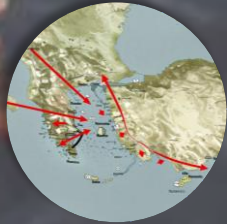
CONCENTRATION OF FORCE

- Naval & air support
- Airborne blocking
- Landings & ground advance



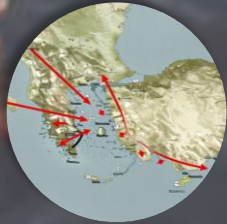
ECONOMY OF EFFORT

- Focus essential resources on the main effort



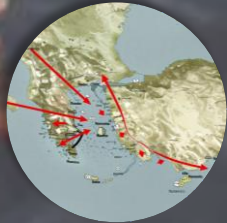
FLEXIBILITY

- Beachhead → Ports → Rhône Valley
- Shifted focus maintained advance
- Strategic aim remained constant



SECURITY

- FFI intelligence
- Coastal mapping
- Air & naval superiority



COOPERATION

AIRBORNE

FFI + SOF

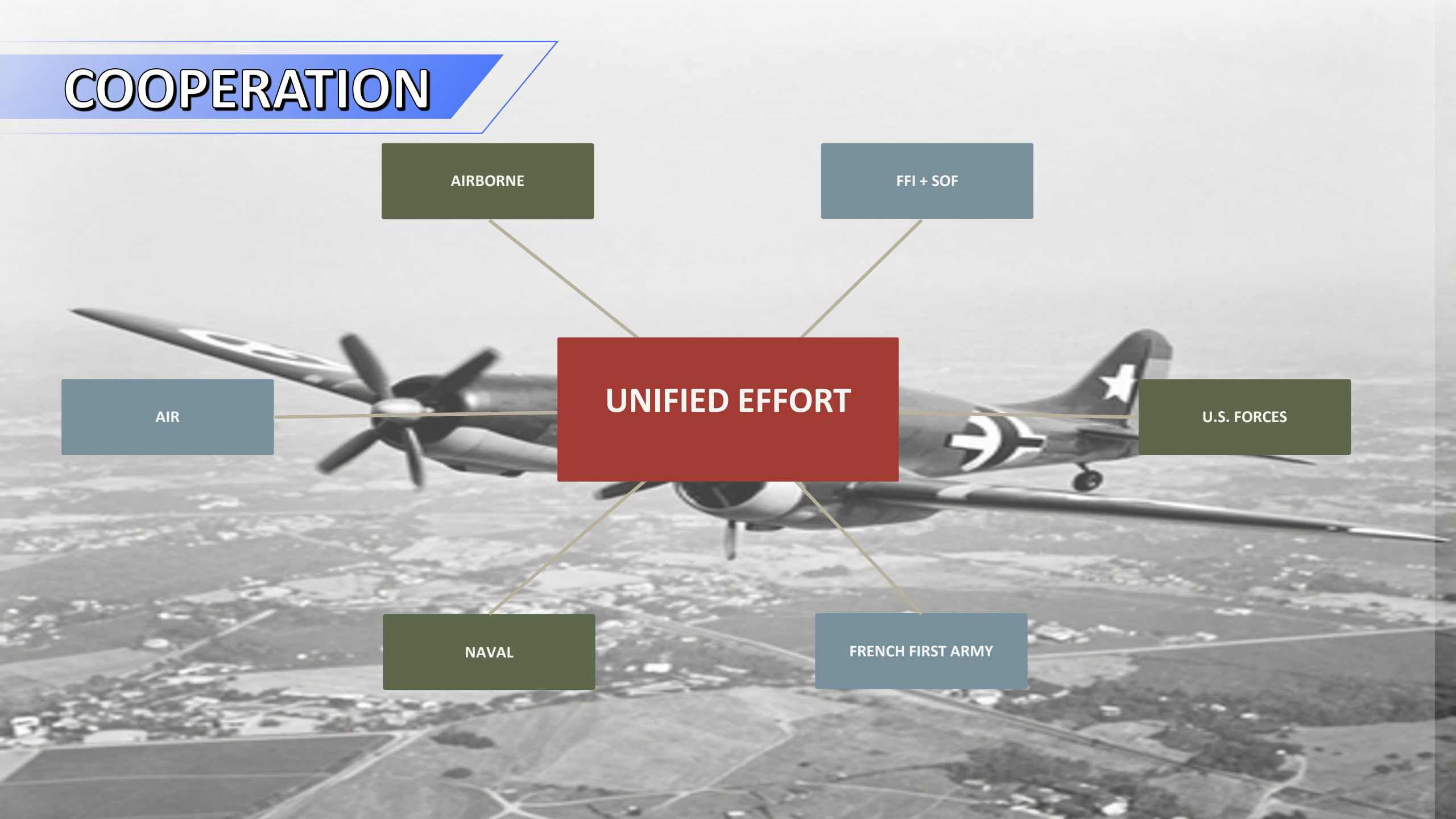
AIR

UNIFIED EFFORT

U.S. FORCES

NAVAL

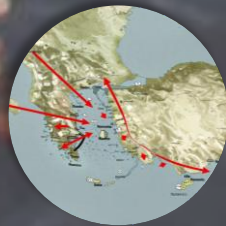
FRENCH FIRST ARMY



ADMINISTRATION



- Toulon & Marseille repairs built enduring capacity
- Port repairs secured lasting capability



The background image is a dark, atmospheric scene. It appears to be a city skyline at night or during a storm, with smoke rising from the buildings. The foreground is dark and rainy, with some small, glowing orange lights scattered across the ground. The word 'CONCLUSION' is written in a large, white, sans-serif font, centered horizontally and vertically.

CONCLUSION

CONCLUSION

**DRAGOON TURNED
INTEGRATION INTO
OPERATIONAL REACH.**



TOULON + MARSEILLE

KEY OBJECTIVES

- 15 Aug 1944 Southern France
- Establish beachhead
- Capture Toulon & Marseille
- Support Allied advance
- Clear objective



PRINCIPLES DEMONSTRATED



- **Objective** - Clear goals
- **Surprise** - Dawn attack
- **Mass** - Combined forces
- **Offensive** - Continuous advance
- **Coordination** - Joint action



KEY LESSONS



- **Plan**
- **Coordinate**
- **Stay disciplined**
- **Act decisively**
- **Focus on objective**



Q & A ? !

A black and white photograph showing a soldier in a trench, viewed through a dark, irregular opening. The soldier is wearing a helmet and a dark uniform, and is positioned in the middle ground. The trench is filled with earth and debris. In the background, there are ruins of buildings and smoke rising from the distance, suggesting a battlefield. The text "THANK YOU" is overlaid in a large, bold, black, sans-serif font across the center of the image.

THANK YOU